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MIL-DTL-14656A
18 December 1998
SUPERSEDING
MIL-B-14656
2 October 1992

DETAIL SPECIFICATION

BUCKLE AND CATCH, CEREMONIAL, ARMY

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers belt buckles and catches used with the U.S. Army Ceremonial Uniform for both Officers and Enlisted Personnel (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification. The insignia covered by this specification are of the following types, styles and classes as specified (See 6.2).

Type I - Buckle and Catch, Ceremonial, U.S. Army, Officers

Type II - Buckle and Catch, Ceremonial, U.S. Army, Enlisted Personnel

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 General. The documents listed in this section are specified in sections 3 and 4 of this specification. This section does not include documents cited in other sections of this specification or recommended for additional information or as examples. While every effort has been made to ensure the completeness of this list, document users are cautioned that they must meet all specified requirements documents cited in sections 3 and 4 of this specification, whether or not they are listed.

2.2 Government documents.

2.2.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in preparing this document should be addressed to: Director, The Institute of Heraldry, US Army, 9325 Gunston Road, Room S112, Fort Belvoir, VA 22060-5579, by using the Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document.

AMSC N/A FSC 8315
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specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-151 – Metal, Test Methods

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of the above specifications, standards and handbooks are available from the Standardization Document Order Desk, 700 Robbins Avenue, Building 4D, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

2.2.2 Other Government documents, drawings and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

STANDARD CHIP SETS

THE INSTITUTE OF HERALDRY, U.S. ARMY STANDARD METAL FINISH CHIP SET

DRAWINGS

THE INSTITUTE OF HERALDRY

B-6-6 - Belt Buckle And Catch, Ceremonial (Ep)
B-6-6A - Belt Buckle & Catch, Ceremonial (Enlisted), Alternate Assembly & Details
B-6-32 - Belt Buckle And Catch, U.S. Army Ceremonial, Officers

(Figures 1, 2, and 3 are miniature copies of Institute of Heraldry drawings and are for information only. Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and specification sheets required by the contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.3 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DoDISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DoDISS are issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.2)

(Non-government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other information services.)

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS

ASTM-B-487 - Metal and Oxide Coating Thickness by Microscopical Examination of a Cross Section, Measurement of

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(Application for copies of ASTM publications should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR QUALITY CONTROL

ANSI/ASQC Z1.4, 1993 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

(Application for copies of ANSI/ASQC Z1.4 should be addressed to the American Society for Quality Control, 611 East Wisconsin Avenue, Milwaukee, Wisconsin 53202.)

2.4 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of' this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.2), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection in accordance with 4.3.

3.2 Recycled, recovered, or environmentally preferable materials. Recycled, recovered, or environmentally preferable materials should be used to the maximum extent possible provided that the material meets or exceeds the operational and maintenance requirements and promotes economically advantageous life cycle costs.

3.3 Materials. Materials shall be as specified herein.

3.3.1 Copper base alloy. The copper base alloy shall be roll polished, free from pits, scale (including red oxide), dents, nicks, cracks, scratches, segregations, and foreign inclusions that will not be removed in later processing. When tested as specified in 4.4.1 the chemical composition of the copper base alloy shall be as specified in Table I.

TABLE 1. **Chemical composition.**

ALLOY	COPPER	LEAD	IRON (MAX)	ZINC (MAX)	OTHER
Red brass	84.0-86.0	.05	.05	Remainder	.15

3.3.2 Screw post and thumb nut. For Type II buckles, the screw post and thumb nut shall be fabricated from any type brass and shall conform to the details and dimensions of drawings B-6-6 and B-6-6A (figures 1 and 2).

3.3.3 Solder. Solder shall be a hard silver alloy solder having a melting point of not less than 1075 degrees Fahrenheit.

3.3.4 Gold for plating. Gold for plating shall be 22 karat.

3.3.5 Nickel for underplating. Nickel for underplating shall be nickel normally used in commercial plating practice.

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3.4 Design. The embossed design of the buckle shall be an exact replica of the design on the Government furnished hubs (see 3.8), from which the contractor's working dies shall be extracted, The working die shall be tooled and polished to remove any dents, nicks, scratches, or other imperfections.

3.5 Construction.

3.5.1 Type I. The buckle shall be constructed in accordance with drawing B-6-32 (Figure 3). The buckle shall be made from red brass specified in 3.3.1.

3.5.1.1 Forcer. A forcer shall be used to bring up the design of Type I buckle. When a forcer is used, the back of the buckle shall have no sharp or rough edges or sharp corners. The impression of the forcer shall be regular and symmetrical upon the face of the buckle. Sufficient metal shall be left near the edges to assure a clean and smooth trimming.

3.5.1.2 Stamping and trimming. The embossed areas for the Type I buckle shall be struck in a manner to ensure a well defined die struck edge. When applicable, embossed areas shall be trimmed and pierced to the die struck outline. All edges shall be clean and smooth, free from burrs, drag, step, and rough edges. The trimming operation, when applicable, shall not damage or distort the design or alter the shape of the design.

3.5.1.3 Soldering. All soldering shall be accomplished using solder specified in 3.3.3. Joints shall be clean, smooth, strong, and free from burned or reduced areas. There shall be no excess solder and all excess flux shall be removed. When tested as specified in 4.6.2, the soldered parts shall not separate.

3.5.1.4 Dapping. The dap for the Type I buckle is built into the Government hub.

3.5.2 Type II. The buckle shall be constructed in accordance with drawings B-6-6 and B-6-6A (Figures 1 and 2). The buckle shall be made from red brass specified in 3.3.1. The coat of arms shall be pierced as shown on Figure 1 and shall be dapped to fit the contour of the buckle. Two screw posts specified in 3.3.2 shall be soldered, or fused, to the back of the coat of arms on the vertical center line. The first screw post shall be one 9/32 inch $\pm$ 1/64 inch from the top of the coat of arms and the second screw post shall be 3/4 inch $\pm$ 1/64 inch on center from the first screw post. After finishing, the coat of arms shall be mounted on the buckle by means of two thumb nuts specified in 3.3.2. The loop for Type II may be fabricated from flat or round stock at the option of the manufacturer (see Figures 1 and 2).

3.5.2.1 Forcer. A forcer shall be used to bring up the coat of arms design for the Type II buckle. When a forcer is used, the back of the coat of arms shall have no sharp or rough edges or sharp corners. The impression of the forcer shall be regular and symmetrical upon the face of the coat of arms. Sufficient metal shall be left near the edges to assure a clean and smooth trimming.

3.5.2.2 Stamping, trimming, and piercing. The embossed areas shall be struck in a manner to ensure a well defined die struck edge. When applicable, embossed areas shall be trimmed and pierced to the die struck outline. All edges shall be clean and smooth, free from burrs, drag, step, and rough edges. The piercing and trimming operations, when applicable, shall not damage or distort the design or alter the shape of the coat of arms.

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3.5.2.3 Soldering. All soldering shall be accomplished using solder specified in 3.3.3. Joints shall be clean, smooth, strong and free from burned or reduced areas. There shall be no excess solder and all excess flux shall be removed. When tested as specified in 4.6.2, the soldered parts shall not separate.

3.5.2.4 Dapping. The insignia and the buckle plate for Type II shall be dapped as shown on TIOH drawings B-6-6 and B-6-6A (Figures 1 and 2).

3.6 Detail of components.

3.6.1 Type I. Type I buckle shall consist of a catch plate and a buckle plate.

3.6.1.1 Catch plate. The catch plate shall be fabricated from red brass specified in 3.3.1 and shall conform to the details and dimensions shown on drawing B-6-32 (Figure 3). The loop shall be hard soldered in the location shown on the drawings. Care should be taken to assure free movement of the sliding bar.

3.6.1.2 Buckle plate. Buckle plates shall be fabricated from red brass specified in 3.3.1 and shall conform to the details and dimensions shown on drawings B-6-32 (Figure 3). The loop and hook shall be hard soldered to the back of the buckle plate in the locations shown on the drawing. Care should be taken to assure free movement of the slide bar from the buckle plate to the top of the loop.

3.6.2 Type II. Type II buckle shall consist of a catch plate and a buckle plate. The buckle shall consist of embossed insignia superimposed and secured by means of two thumb nuts to the buckle plate and a catch plate assembly.

3.6.2.1 Coat of Arms. The coat of arms shall be fabricated from red brass specified in 3.3.1. The finished insignia shall have a thickness of not less than 3/64 inch at the shield and shall be provided with brass screw post located as shown on drawing B-6-6 (Figure 1).

3.6.2.2 Catch plate. The catch plate shall be fabricated from red brass specified in 3.3.1 and shall conform to the details and dimensions shown on drawings B-6-6 and B-6-6A (Figures 1 and 2). The loop shall be hard soldered in the location shown on the drawings. Care should be taken to assure free movement of the sliding bar.

3.6.2.3 Buckle plate. Buckle plates shall be fabricated from red brass specified in 3.3.1 and shall conform to the details and dimensions shown on drawings B-6-6 and B-6-6A (Figure 1 and 2). The loop and hooks shall be hard soldered to the back of the buckle plate in the locations shown on the drawing. Care should be taken to assure free movement of the slide bar from the buckle plate to the top of the loop.

3.7 Finish. The finish shall match the TIOH Metal Finish Chip specified in 3.7.1, 3.7.2.1, 3.7.2.2, or 3.7.3.

3.7.1 Coat of arms. The coat of arms for Type II shall be gold plated matte finish with polished highlights and shall match TIOH Metal Finish Chip Number 11.

3.7.2 Buckle plate.

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3.7.2.1 Type I. The face of the Type I buckle plate shall be gold plated,matte finish with polished highlights and shall match TIOH Metal Finish Chip Number 11. The entire buckle shall be gold plated..

3.7.2.2 Type II. The face of the Type II buckle plate shall be gold plated mirror-like polished and shall match TIOH Metal Finish Chip Number 9. The entire buckle shall be gold plated.

3.7.3 Catch plate. The catch plate shall be gold plated with a mirror-like polished finish and shall match TIOH Metal Finish Chip Number 9.

3.7.4 Gold plating. All plating shall be by electroplating methods. The plating shall be continuous and unbroken over the entire plated surface. There shall be no cut-through, shade, peeled, or blistered plating. Plating of attaching devices hall not be required.

3.7.4.1 22 karat gold plating. The gold plating shall be accomplished using gold specified in 3.3.4. When tested as specified in 4.6.1, no visible chemical reaction such as evolution of gases shall appear.

3.7.4.2 Nickel underplating. Nickel underplating shall be accomplished using nickel specified in 3.3.5 and shall be not less than 0.0003 inch thick. Testing shall be standard commercial. In case of a dispute, testing shall be in accordance with ASTM-B-487.

3.8 Government loaned property. Hubs will be furnished by the Government and shall be used to make the contractor's working dies necessary for one contract or order (see 3.4).

3.9 Marking. The contractor shall stamp his trademark or other identifying mark legibly and inconspicuously on the back of the buckle tongue. There shall be no signs of penetration or unevenness on the surface opposite the marked area. The marking shall not distort any part of the buckle.

3.10 Workmanship. Buckles shall be clean, well made, and shall meet the acceptable quality level established by this specification.

4. VERIFICATION

4.1 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).

b. Conformance inspection (see 4.4).

4.2 Inspection conditions. Unless otherwise specified, all inspection shall be performed in accordance with the test conditions specified in 4.4.

4.3 First article inspection. Inspection and testing of the first article (see 3.1 and 6.3) shall be made of a completely finished item for all provisions of this specification applicable to the end product examination and tests.

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4.4 Conformance inspection. Quality assurance inspection of components and materials shall be in accordance with the subsidiary specifications and drawings. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with ANSI/ASQC Z1.4.

4.4.1 Testing of components. Inspection shall be performed on components and materials listed in Table II for the test characteristics shown therein.

TABLE II. **Testing of components.**

COMPONENT	CHARACTERISTIC	RQM'T ¶	TEST METHOD	RESULTS REPORTED AS
Copper base alloy (1 lb)	chemical composition	3.3.1	4.6.3	nearest 0.1%

4.4.2 In-process inspection. In-process inspection shall be made at any point or during any phase of the manufacturing process to determine whether operation or assemblies are accomplished as specified. The Government reserves the right to exclude from consideration for acceptance any material for which in-process inspection has indicated nonconformance. In-process inspection shall be conducted to see that accomplishment of the following is in accordance with the specification requirements.

REQUIREMENT, OPERRATION, OR ASSEMBLY	RQM'T ¶
Gold plating of coat of arms	3.7.1
Soldering of screw posts to back of coat of arms	3.5.2
Thickness of metal for design	B-6-6, B-6-6A, or B-6-32

4.5. Inspection of the end item.

4.5.1 Visual examination of buckles. Examination of buckles for defects in finish, design, material, construction, workmanship, and marking shall be made using Table III. Examination shall be made at a distance of approximately 16 to 22 inches with illumination equal to average daylight and arranged so as to avoid as much reflected light as possible. Defects designated by an asterisk (✳) shall be classified as major when seriously affecting appearance or serviceability and minor when affecting appearance or serviceability but not seriously. The product unit for the examinations shall be one completely fabricated buckle. Any dimension which is not within the specified tolerance shall be classified as a defect.

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TABLE III **Defects.**

EXAMINE	DEFECT	CLASSIFICATION		
		MAJOR	(*)	MINOR
Color & finish	Color & finish of buckle does not compare favorably with the standard sample		*	
	Pits, scale, pin holes, crack, rupture, segregation, or foreign inclusion		*	
	Not gold plated	X		
	Buff, drag, or cloudy finish		*	
	Any plated area cut-through, shaded, peeled, or blistered	X		
	Discoloration such as spot, stain, or speck		*	
	Not clean or foreign matter imbedded ...		*	
Plating	Not plated when required	X		
	Not type specified	X		
	Not smooth, continuous, or adherent	X		
	Cut through or porous	X		
Design	Details altered, does not conform to Government hub or drawing	X		
	Any detail struck over resulting in double impression		*	
	Any significant detail, marred, missing, reduced, obliterated, or unclear		*	
	Any area not pierced as indicated by drawing	X		
	Any warp, twist, or distortion producing irregular surface contour or outline	X		
	Not dapped as indicated by drawing	X		
Construction & Workmanship	Metal marks such as nicks, cracks, dents, digs, gouges, or scratches		*	
	Not trimmed to die-struck edge			X
	Die struck edge not well defined			X
	Edge not die-struck		*	
	Pinhole, crack, or rupture		*	
	Any sharp or rough edge, burr, drag or step, or tool marks		*	
	Coat of arms not closely dapped to fit contour of buckle	X		
	Any component missing, bent, twisted, broken, deformed, or otherwise impaired		*	
	Screw post missing	X		
	Movement of slide bar restricted		*	
	Not pierced when required	X		

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EXAMINE	DEFECT	CLASSIFICATION		
		MAJOR	(✳)	MINOR
	Piercing not clean & smooth ……		✳	
	Piercing operation distorts insignia ……		✳	
	Coat of arms out of alignment …….	X		
	Any area burned or reduced in soldering or acid cleaning …….		✳	
	Soldered area not clean or smooth, i.e., flux or excess solder not removed …..		✳	
	Penetration of marking to opposite surface, unevenness, or distortion …..	X		
Soldering	Component parts not joined by soldering; any perceptible opening between component parts ……	X		
	Joints not clean and smooth, i.e., flux or excess solder not removed ……..			X
	Burned or reduced areas …….	X		
.	Not silver solder …….	X		
Assembly	Center line of coat of arms out of alignment …….	X		
	Coat of arms not securely mounted on the buckle, i.e., one or more thumb nuts missing …….	X		
	Thumb nuts not securely tightened ……			X
Marking	Missing, illegible, incorrect, or incomplete ……..			X
	Conspicuously placed ……..		✳	

4.5.1.1 Examination of the buckle for defects in dimensions. Any dimension which is not within the specified tolerance shall be classified as a defect.

4.5.2. End item testing. Testing of the completely fabricated buckle shall be performed in accordance with Table IV for the characteristics shown therein. The sample unit shall be one buckle.

TABLE IV. **Testing of end item.**

CHARACTERISTIC	RQM'T ¶	TEST METHOD	RESULTS REPORTED AS
Acid test for gold plating	3.3.4	4.6.1	pass/fail
Test for soldered joints	3.3.3	4.6.2	pass/fail

4.6 Tests.

4.6.1 Acid test for gold plating. The test acid shall be applied as follows: Place a drop of acid of not less than 1/16 inch in diameter on three different spots on the front face of

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the buckle allowing the drops to remain for not less than one (1) minute during which time the surface of the buckle shall be inspected to determine compliance with the requirements of 3.7.4. A minimum of two spots must withstand the acid test. The test acid shall be applied at room temperature (60 to 80 degrees Fahrenheit) and shall consist of a solution containing 50 percent by volume of chemically pure nitric acid (specific gravity 1.42) and an equal volume of distilled water.

4.6.2 Test for hard soldered joints. Hard soldered joints to be tested shall be placed in an oven maintained at 1075 degrees Fahrenheit ± 5 degrees Fahrenheit for not less than 15 minutes. While at this temperature, the items shall be lifted by the coat of arms or soldered edge and the joints examined for compliance with 3.5.1.3.

4.6.3 Chemical composition test. Chemical composition shall be determined in accordance with Test Method No. 111.1 of FED-STD-151. Results shall be evaluated to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.3.1.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. For acquisition purposes, the packaging requirements shall be as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2). When actual packaging of materiel is to be performed by DoD personnel, these personnel need to contact the responsible packaging activity to ascertain requisite packaging requirements. Packaging requirements are maintained by the Inventory Control Point's packaging activity within the Military Department or Defense Agency, or within the Military Department's System Command. Packaging data retrieval is available from the managing Military Department's or Defense Agency's automated packaging files, CD-ROM products, or by contacting the responsible packaging activity.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. The buckles covered by this specification are intended to be used as an accessory to the uniforms worn by officers and enlisted personnel of honor units and the Army Band during formal military ceremonies.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.

b. Type classification of buckle required (see 1.2).

c. Issue of DoDISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.2).

d. When a first article is not required (see 3.2).

e. Packaging requirements (see 5.1).

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f. Drawing number (see 2.2.2, 3.5.1, and 3.5.2).

6.3 First article. When first article inspection is required, the contracting officer should provide specific guidance to offerors whether the item should be a preproduction sample, a first production sample, or a standard production item from the contractor's current inventory as specified in 4.3. The first article should consist of one completed item. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for examination, approval of first article test results, and disposition of first articles. Invitations for bids should provide that the Government reserves the right to waive the requirement for samples for first article inspection to those bidders offering a product which has been previously acquired or tested by the Government, and that bidders offering such products, who wish to rely on such production or tests, must furnish evidence with the bid that prior Government approval is presently appropriate for the pending contract.

6.4. Government loaned property. The contracting officer should arrange to loan the property listed in 3.8.

6.4 Subject term (key word) listing.

Ceremonial
Coat of Arms
Insignia

6.5 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extent of the changes.

Custodians:
Army - IH

Preparing activity:
Army - IH

Review activities:
Army – GL
DLA - CT

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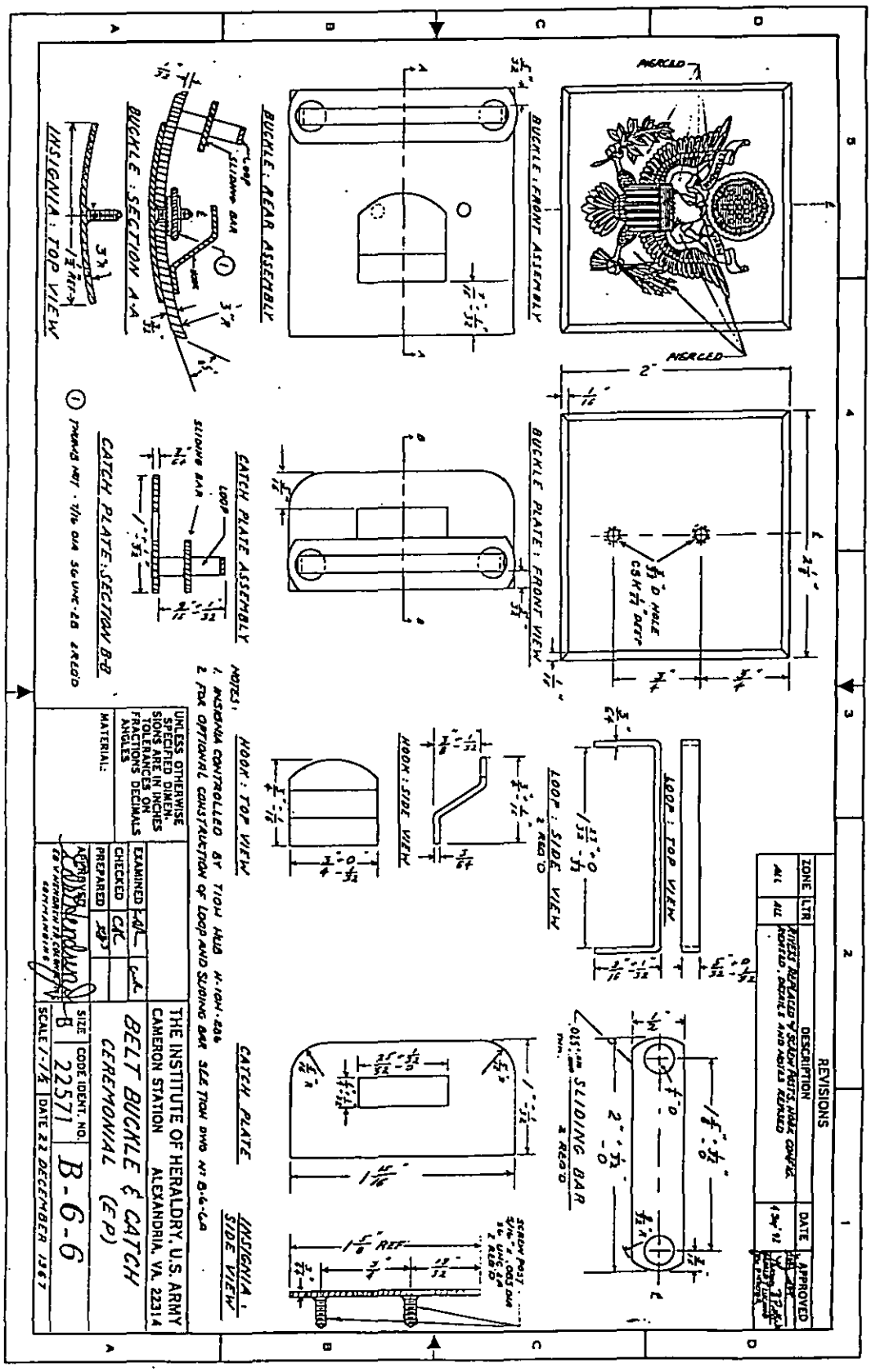


FIGURE 1. **Belt buckle & catch, ceremonial (ep)**

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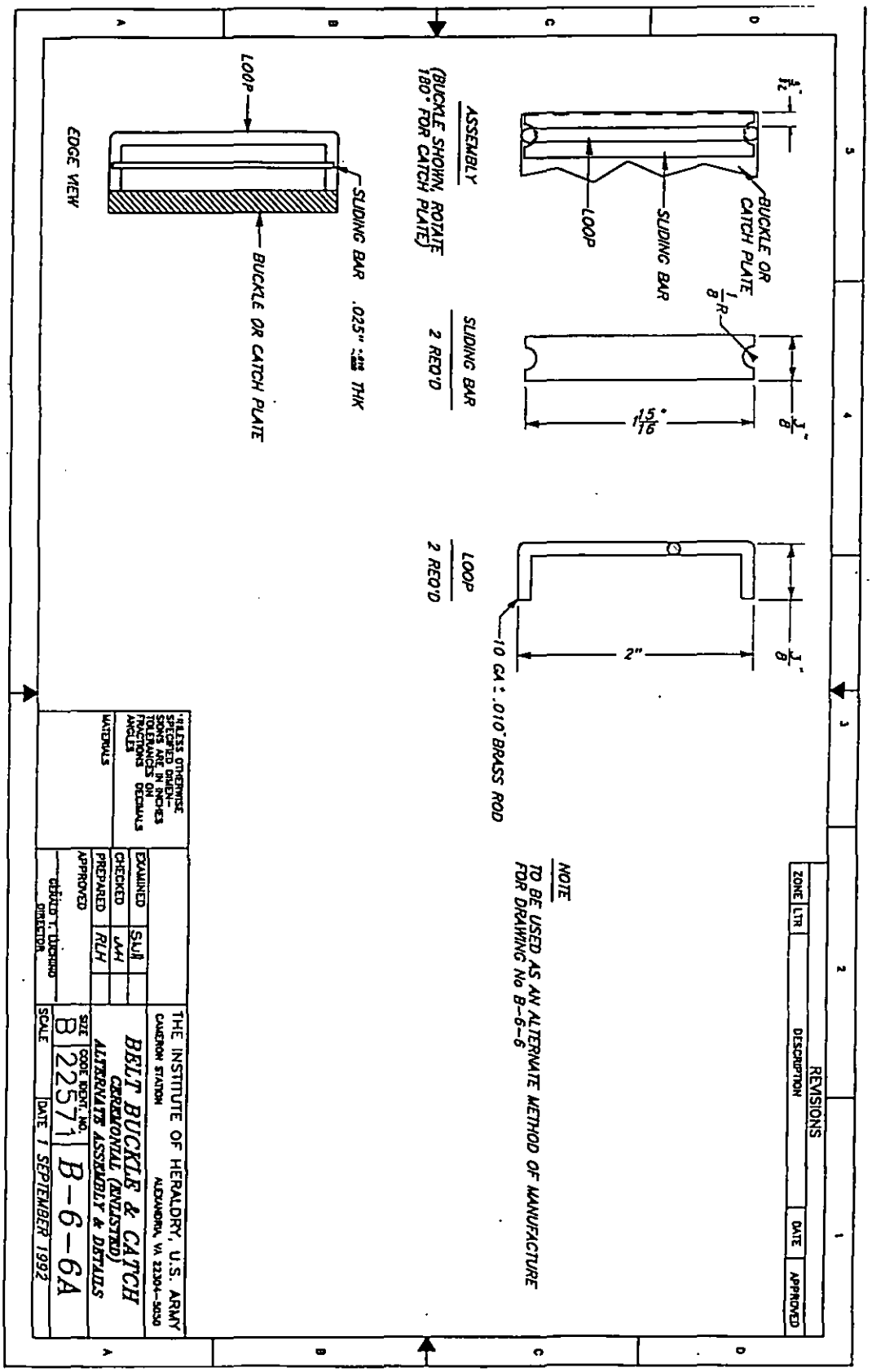


FIGURE 2. **Belt buckle & catch, ceremonial (enlisted), alternate assembly & details**

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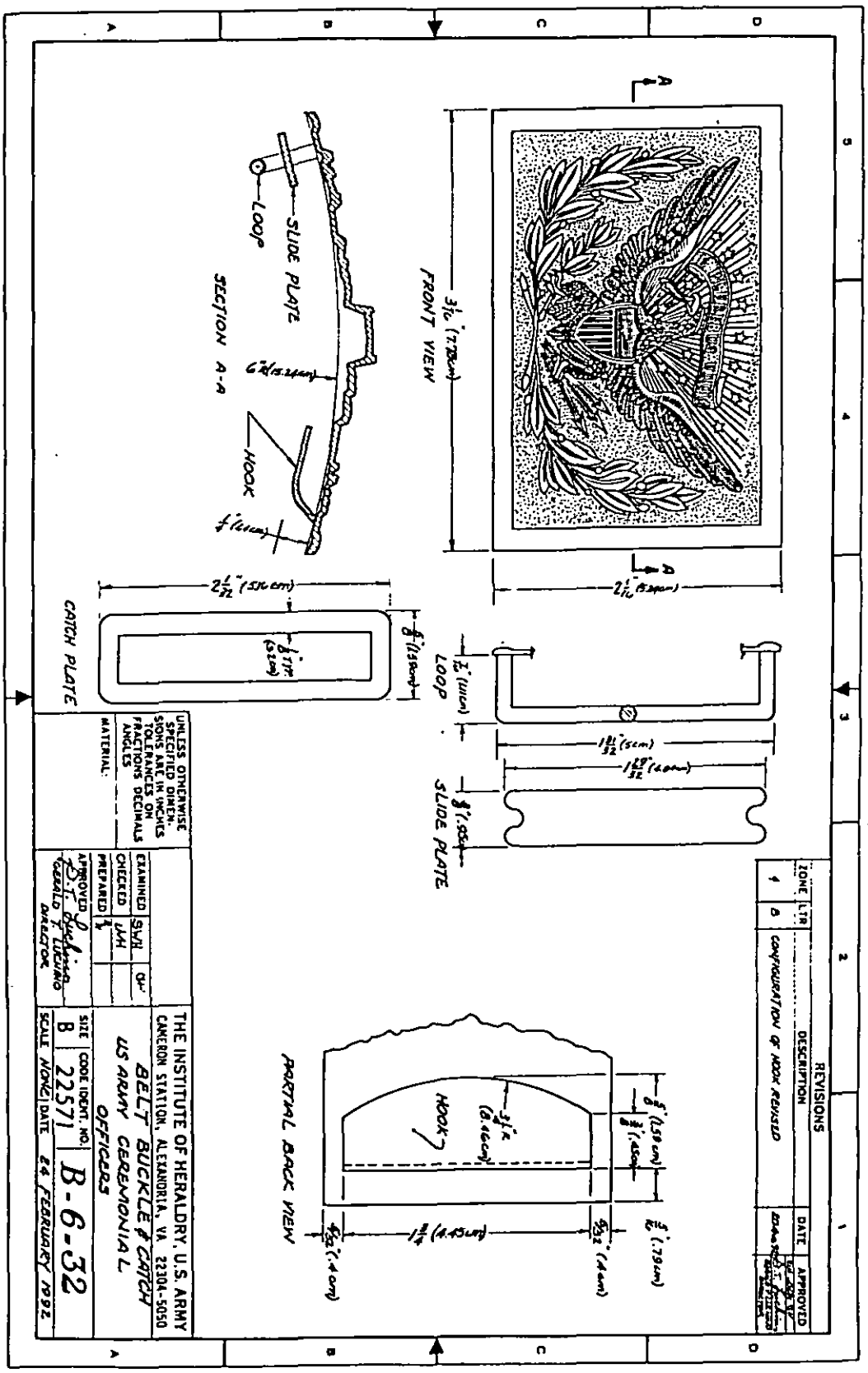


FIGURE 3. **Belt buckle & catch, U.S. Army ceremonial, officers**

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT DATE *(YYMMDD)*
	MIL-DTL-14656A	981218

3. DOCUMENT TITLE
BUCKLE AND CATCH, CEREMONIAL, ARMY

4. NATURE OF CHANGE *(Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)*

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME *(Last, First, Middle Initial)*	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS *(Include Zip Code)*	d. TELEPHONE *(Include Area Code)* (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON *(If applicable)*	7. DATE SUBMITTED *(YYMMDD)*

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial	(2) AUTOVON
The Institute of Heraldry, U.S. Army	(703) 806-4982	DSN 656-4982
c. ADDRESS *(Include Zip Code)* Technical and Production Division 9325 Gunston Road, Bldg. 1466, Rm. S-112 Fort Belvoir, VA 22060-5579	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340	

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